

- **Buy a City Savings Book** – For \$20-\$30, you can purchase a paperback book filled with local deals and coupons. It's easy to stash this book away and forget about it, so keep it within eyesight! Even better if it's accessible within your car to use whenever you go out.
- **Save Your Receipt** – The next time you throw a receipt away, take a second look—there might be a coupon on it! Many restaurants reward you for taking a two-minute survey on their website or over the phone, and will offer a free food item or 15% off your next meal in return.
- **Check Groupon.com** – Groupon is a great place to find a deal on local restaurants, and gives you the opportunity to try new dives for less. You never know what hidden gem you might find in your neighborhood!

READER TIP:

This year, I purchased an Attractions Dining and Value Guide (attractionsbook.com) for our area (think the entertainment books schools sell) for \$25. We've already made our money back and we've only had it 1.5 months. I've given coupons to some coworkers and parents as well, so I'm spreading the joy too!

—Kim, VA

3. ORDER WATER

Joseph used to work in the restaurant industry, and I was shocked when he told me what kind of profit margin eating establishments make on drinks, especially soda. What costs essentially pennies for syrup and carbonation translates into \$2-\$4 per person on your bill, not including refills!

Water is such an easy replacement and doesn't cost a thing. You are better off health-wise too.